support their decisions. This approach makes sure that the reasoning behind each policy clearly states the compliance areas it covers. Each policy file also has metadata in its comment section—tags like `sox:access-review` or `gdpr:data-access`—so compliance reporting tools can automatically link policies to their respective controls. When auditors ask for evidence, coordinators can provide the appropriate policies, ADRs, and decision logs that show how those regulatory requirements are fulfilled in practice.

Automated assurance also plays an increasingly important role. ACME's CI/CD pipeline continuously runs policy validations against test scenarios based on compliance controls. For instance, GDPR-related policies are tested to verify that access to data labeled as *personal* or *export-restricted* always requires proper contextual justification. Violations generate alerts and prevent policy deployment until they are resolved. This methodology shifts compliance from being a periodic task to a continuous, testable feature of the authorization system.

Policy governance also improves accountability after an incident. When a privacy- or access-control-related breach occurs, engineers commenting on the event in the incident-management system reference the relevant ADRs that describe the impacted policies. These references help investigators, coordinators, and auditors trace how authorization decisions were made and why the underlying policy was in place. During postmortem reviews, the governance team links runtime behavior, policy logic, and documented intent to find any gaps in design or enforcement. This structured visibility gives ACME confidence that its authorization system can withstand regulatory scrutiny without relying on manual reconstruction or incomplete evidence.

Governance thus turns compliance into a result of good engineering practice. By integrating traceability, testing, and auditing into the policy lifecycle, ACME no longer views compliance as an external requirement but as an essential aspect of its approach to managing authorization. In this way, regulation becomes not a restriction but a guiding principle, helping the organization continually refine its expression of institutional will.